Skills and Qualifications

Education and Training

1. What was your major, and why did you choose it?
2. Which class or teacher actually stuck with you, and what did they teach you?
3. Was your school better at teaching theory or at preparing you for a real job?
4. How much of what you studied do you still use at work today?
5. Did you do an internship, and how did it compare with your classes?
6. Looking back, what would you have studied differently?
7. Is a degree from a top university still worth the pressure in 2026?

Skills Employers Ask For

1. Think of the last job ad you read. Which skills kept appearing?
2. Which of those skills does your own job actually need every day?
3. Are these skills usually written as soft or hard skills in the ad? Why?
4. If you could only list three skills on your resume, which three and why?
5. Which skill do Chinese employers value more than foreign ones do?
6. Which skill is easiest to prove in an interview, and how would you prove it?
7. Do certificates and scores really show how good you are at a skill?

Your Strong Points and Weak Spots

1. What are you genuinely good at, and how did you find out?
2. Name one skill you are proud of. How did you build it?
3. What is one weakness you are working on right now?
4. How would a close colleague describe your strongest skill?
5. Is there a skill everyone expects you to have but you actually lack?
6. How do you respond when a job asks for a skill you don't have yet?

Learning New Skills

1. How do you prefer to learn: hands-on practice, a course, a tutor, or videos?
2. What skill did you teach yourself, and what made you stick with it?
3. How much time can you honestly spend learning after a long workday?
4. Do you learn faster from a mentor or from your own mistakes? Give an example.
5. Which skill do you want to learn this year, and what is stopping you?
6. How has AI changed the way you pick up a new skill?

Study vs Work Experience

1. Which teaches you more about a real job: university or the first year at work?
2. What do you make of everyone rushing to get an MBA these days?
3. Two years of work experience or a master's overseas — which would you choose?
4. Does your company actually pay more for a higher degree?
5. Is further study worth it if you have to stop working and lose income?
6. Which jobs in your field truly need a master's, and which just list it?
7. If your company offered paid study leave, what would you study?

Training at Work

1. Does your company train new hires properly, or is it sink-or-swim?
2. Which job do you think needs the most training before day one?
3. Do you think all jobs need training? Why or why not?
4. When training is boring, how do you keep yourself engaged?
5. How would you redesign onboarding for your own company?
6. What is one thing your manager could teach you if you asked?